Then, with my score on 30, Shane Warne let rip with probably the best ball I've ever faced from a spinner. He was getting a lot of in-drift and turn from the ball, and the length of this delivery was just perfect. I couldn't go 'back to' and I couldn't go 'forward to'. I didn't want to sweep the ball either, because I didn't think it was full enough. The ball was right on the money and caught me playing from the crease. It hit the deck outside leg, spun past my bat and knocked the bail off my off-stump.

I heard their wicketkeeper, Adam Gilchrist, go up, and I remember thinking, 'What the hell's he going on about?' I didn't think there was any way Warne could've bowled me. I mean, I didn't even hear the bails come off! But I turned around and saw that one of the bails *had* come off. The *perfect* ball … perfect. Warney reckons it's the second-best ball he's ever bowled (the best being the one he bowled to get Mike Gatting in the 1993 Ashes series).

As we all know, this semi-final was one of *the* toughest games South African cricket fans have ever had to watch. After it looked like we were dead and buried, Lance 'Zulu' Klusener brought us back to the brink of victory … and then that notorious runout happened. During the game, I couldn't even watch the last 20 overs. I couldn't bear it. I was in the physio room with Nicky Bojé and I looked only at his face for his reactions, while he was watching the telly.

Lance hit two fours in the last over and then almost got run out. And then we did get run out. I mean, our emotions went from rock-bottom to ecstasy and then all the way down again in the space of half a minute!

With the run-out in the last over, the scores were level, which meant that the Australians would go through to the finals, as they had finished higher than us in the earlier Super Six round. I remember the atmosphere in the dressing room afterwards … you could virtually hear a pin drop for at least ten minutes after coming off the field. No one said a word. We just couldn't believe it.

It was rough. I mean, there's dead silence in our changing room and next door – back then at Edgbaston the changing rooms used to be right next door to each other – they're going bananas. I still haven't asked Zulu or Allan to this day what actually happened out there; it's something I just want to forget.

Our coach Bob Woolmer said a few words, and then Hansie made a speech. He said how proud he was of the way in which we had gone about